

PRINCIPLES OF EFFECTIVE CPD

This poster is a summary of Carousel Teaching's guide to effective CPD. Teachers and leaders are encouraged to first read the guide, and then use the poster as an aide memoire.



1. As a leader, ensure you have deep content knowledge

A comprehensive understanding allows you to contextualise training for your school and to build credibility. CPD will not be effective if staff cannot see you "practising what you preach" with authority and expertise.



2. Don't overload, and plan your calendar

Avoid cognitive overload by limiting training to two or three concrete strategies per session. Plan a responsive implementation calendar where you only move forward once strategies are embedded.



3. Revisit prior learning

Treat colleagues as learners: begin every session with a review or quiz to strengthen long-term memory and assess retention of core ideas.



4. Provide clear, concrete exemplification

Demonstrate exactly what your CPD looks like in action by using authentic classroom footage or live modeling to provide a clear picture of good classroom implementation.



5. Involve the room

Replace passive lectures with high-participation sessions. Pre-planned scenarios and mini-whiteboards can help ensure every colleague is actively thinking and participating.



6. Check understanding

Use quizzes with high-quality distractors to unearth misconceptions and deepen expertise before staff move on to implementation planning.



7. Allow dedicated departmental planning time

Generic strategies must be adapted into subject-specific contexts. Providing dedicated departmental time gives teachers the autonomy they need to implement change in a way that is true to their subject.



8. Aim for task cohesion across staff

High-impact CPD builds a common professional language and consistent classroom routines. When staff align on core strategies, predictability for students increases, amplifying the overall effect on school-wide outcomes.



9. Secure buy-in through quality experience

Low buy-in is often a response to negative experiences of past CPD and initiative management, not teacher apathy. Tailoring your CPD to the principles outlined here should therefore naturally improve buy-in.